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Danilo Rodrigues dos Santos

SENIOR GAME PROGRAMMER

Unreal Engine 5 · C++ · Gameplay · Multiplayer & Networking · Console Porting & Optimization

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SUMMARY

Game programmer with nearly 8 years across the full development lifecycle, specializing in Unreal Engine 5 and C++. I build and ship commercial titles for PlayStation, Xbox, Nintendo Switch, PC and mobile — from stylized multiplayer shooters to family party games — as a systems programmer, technical lead and porting lead. Deep experience in gameplay systems, multiplayer networking and replication, performance optimization, and platform certification (TRC/XR), with a track record of owning complex systems end to end and shipping them to certification on every major console.

CORE SKILLS

- LANGUAGES** C++, C#, Blueprint Visual Scripting
- ENGINES** Unreal Engine 5, Unreal Engine 4, Unity
- GAMEPLAY SYSTEMS** Gameplay Ability System (GAS), weapon & combat systems, ballistics, character traversal & climbing, input buffering, NPC behavior & AI, inventory, game modes
- MULTIPLAYER & NETWORKING** Replication, server-client architecture, dedicated servers (AWS), cross-platform synchronization
- UI** CommonUI, UMG, gamepad-native navigation
- PERFORMANCE & OPTIMIZATION** CPU/GPU & memory profiling, frame-rate optimization, Level Streaming, console memory constraints
- PORTING & CERTIFICATION** Platform certification (Sony TRC / Microsoft XR), Achievements, Trophies & Activities; Sony Partner Center, Microsoft Partner Center, Nintendo Developer Portal, Epic Developer Portal
- TOOLS & PIPELINES** Custom level-design tools, Wwise audio middleware, Jenkins (CI)
- VERSION CONTROL** Perforce, Git, SVN
- PLATFORMS** PlayStation 5/4, Xbox Series X|S, Xbox One, Nintendo Switch, PC (Steam, Microsoft Store), Android, iOS

EXPERIENCE

Senior Unreal Developer — Magic Media Contract · Remote · Nov 2025 – Feb 2026

Unannounced AA souls-like FPS – console port · PS5, Xbox Series X|S

- Ported an AA souls-like FPS from PC to PS5 and Xbox Series X|S, holding feature parity and stability while the title remained in active development.
- Implemented platform features — Achievements, Trophies and Activities — and managed technical configuration to meet full certification compliance (Sony TRCs / Microsoft XRs).
- Built gamepad-native UI navigation with the CommonUI framework, turning UX design into a seamless console experience.
- Profiled and optimized CPU/GPU and memory to hold frame-rate targets within console limits.

Stack UE5 · C++ · Perforce

Senior Game Developer — Beta Games Group Contract · Remote · Sep 2025 – Nov 2025

171 – GTA-inspired open-world action · Steam (Early Access)

- Re-engineered the core architecture of an open-world action title alongside the Project Lead, owning Inventory, Weapon Mechanics, Ballistics and NPC Behavior.
- Implemented the Gameplay Ability System (GAS) from the ground up — a data-driven framework for attribute sets, ability logic and gameplay effects, built for scale.
- Integrated Unreal's Motion Matching to bring locomotion and combat animation up to genre standard.

Stack UE5 · C++ · Git

Senior Game Developer — Hype Joe GamesRemote · Jul 2024 – Sep 2025

Uniqkiller: Urban Shooter – cross-platform multiplayer shooter · Steam, Android, iOS

- Owned all networked gameplay systems — replication and server-client architecture — delivering responsive, synchronized play across PC and mobile on dedicated AWS servers.
 - Built core gameplay: weapon system, aiming mechanics, game modes and RPG progression.
 - Integrated cross-platform authentication with a custom backend, persisting player accounts and progress across sessions and devices.
 - Packaged, certified and published the title to Google Play and the App Store.
- StackUE5 · C++ · AWS · Git

Mid-Level Game Engineer — 1518 Studios by PTWContract · Remote · Dec 2023 – Apr 2024

Sunnyside – console port · PS5, Xbox Series X|S

- Helped stand up and grow a console-porting pipeline, defining core console-development requirements and overseeing the release process.
 - Drove the port of a PC title to PS5 and Xbox Series X|S, focused on optimization and certification while the game was still in active development.
- StackUE5 · C++ · Perforce

Senior Console Porting & Game Engineer — DXGameworksRemote · May 2021 – Nov 2023

That's My Family (Switch, PS4, Xbox One) · Supraland: Six Inches Under (PS, Xbox, MS Store) · Unannounced AA action-adventure

- As Technical Lead, delivered That's My Family: Family Fun Night (UE5) to Switch, PS4 and Xbox One — architected a shared, data-driven framework powering 14 classic games from common code plus a single rule-fed AI, shipping on schedule from concept to certified launch.
 - Directed the console port of Supraland: Six Inches Under (UE4) to PS4/PS5, Xbox One/Series X|S and Microsoft Store — re-engineered the save system into a queued, console-compliant pipeline and used Level Streaming with a custom object freeze/unfreeze system to fit the open world into Nintendo Switch memory without breaking backtracking.
 - Co-developed an unannounced AA cinematic action-adventure (UE5): character traversal and climbing, input buffering for combat responsiveness, puzzle-interaction systems, modular NPC behavior, an investigation/journal system, custom level-design tools, and Wwise audio & localized-subtitle integration.
 - Contributed to additional console ports across UE4, UE5 and Unity.
- StackUE5 · UE4 · Unity · C++ · Perforce · Wwise

Console Porting & Game Engineer — Garage227São Paulo · Sep 2019 – Apr 2021

Niche – a genetics survival game · Switch, Xbox One, PS4

- Executed the full console-porting cycle for Niche – a genetics survival game (Unity) as sole programmer, releasing on Nintendo Switch, Xbox One and PS4 with full certification compliance.
 - Re-engineered keyboard/mouse-only UI and gameplay for gamepad input, integrated console SDKs (starting with Nintendo) and rebuilt the save/load system for console hardware.
- StackUnity · C# · Git

SELECTED SHIPPED TITLES

- Uniqkiller: Urban Shooter (2025) — Gameplay & Networking Programmer · Steam, Android, iOS · UE5
- Sunnyside (2024) — Porting Engineer · PS5, Xbox Series X|S · UE5
- Supraland: Six Inches Under (2023) — Technical Lead, Porting · PS4/5, Xbox One/Series, Microsoft Store · UE4
- That's My Family: Family Fun Night (2023) — Technical Lead · Switch, PS4, Xbox One · UE5
- 171 (Early Access) — Gameplay Systems Programmer · Steam · UE5
- Niche – a genetics survival game (2020) — Sole Porting Programmer · Switch, Xbox One, PS4 · Unity

EDUCATION

B.A. in Game Design

Universidade Anhembi Morumbi, São Paulo · 2015 – 2018

Full game-development lifecycle — gameplay, level design, UI/UX, and cross-platform prototyping.

ADDITIONAL

- Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent — technical interviews & daily work with international teams).
- 6+ shipped commercial titles across PlayStation, Xbox, Switch, PC & mobile.
- Extensive remote experience with distributed international teams.
- Open to remote roles and international relocation.